

Richard Anthony Hall (born 14 March 1972) is an English [football coach](#) and former professional footballer, who is an under-23s coach at [Colchester United](#).

As a player, he was [defender](#) who played in the [Premier League](#) for both [Southampton](#) and [West Ham United](#), having previously played in the [Football League](#) with [Scunthorpe United](#). He made over 30 appearances for Scunthorpe before being signed by Southampton for £200,000 in February 1991. After five years with the south-coast club and over 120 league appearances, Hall earned a £1.4 million move to West Ham in the summer of 1996. He made just eight appearances for the club before he was forced to retire from injury in 1999. While with Southampton, Hall made eleven appearances for [England](#) at [under-21](#) level.^[2]

Hall has served as [caretaker manager](#) of [Colchester United](#), having previously been assistant to [Tony Humes](#). He has also served as a professional development coach for the club, and prior to joining Colchester, he was under-18 coach for his hometown club [Ipswich Town](#).

Club career

Born in [Ipswich](#),^[4] Hall attended [Kesgrave High School](#) and was a member of the [Ipswich Town](#) youth team. He failed to make an appearance for the first-team, instead moving to [Scunthorpe United](#).^[3] Hall spent two years as an apprentice at the club, and a further six months as a professional after signing his first contract.^[4] Between 1988 and 1991, Hall made 31 appearances in all competitions, scoring three goals, before earning a £200,000 move to [Southampton](#) on 13 February 1991.^[4]

Hall made his debut for Southampton on the final day of the [1990–91 season](#) on 11 May 1991 as a substitute for [Neil Ruddock](#) in a [First Division](#) 1–1 draw.^[5] In his five years with the club, Hall made 126 league appearances, scoring 12 goals. He also made 30 cup appearances, scoring a further four goals.^[6]

[Harry Redknapp](#) signed Hall from Southampton for his [West Ham United](#) side in the summer of 1996 for a £1.4 million fee.^[7] An injury in pre-season delayed Hall's preparations for the [1996–97 season](#), eventually making his first-team debut on 9 April 1997 in a 0–0 [Premier League](#) draw with [Middlesbrough](#) at the [Boleyn Ground](#). He made six further appearances until the end of the season. The following two seasons were blighted by injury, and he made his final appearance for West Ham on 13 January 1999 in a 1–0 away defeat to [Swansea City](#) in the [FA Cup](#), coming on as a substitute for [Tim Breacker](#),^{[8][9]} before retiring in April 1999 at the age of 27.^{[3][10]}

International career

Hall made his debut for [England](#) at [under-21 level](#) as a substitute for goalscorer [Andy Cole](#) in England's 2–2 draw with [Hungary](#) on 12 May 1992 in [Vác](#). He made his first start for [Lawrie McMenemy](#)'s side on 28 May in England's [Toulon Tournament](#) draw with [France](#). He scored his first under-21 goal on 16 February 1993 in his third appearance for the side in a 6–0 win over [San Marino](#) at [Luton Town](#)'s [Kenilworth Road](#) stadium in a [1994 European Under-21 Championship](#) [qualifier](#). He also started in a qualifying draw with [Turkey](#) on 30 March and in a 3–0 win over the [Netherlands](#) on 27 April, before he scored his second and final under-21 goal on 28 May 1993, one year to the day since his first start for the side. He scored in the Young Lions' 4–1 win away in [Poland](#).

Hall made further appearances in England's successful 1993 Toulon Tournament side, starting in a 2–0 win over [Portugal](#) and draws against [Czech Republic](#) and [Brazil](#) in the group stages. He also played

in their semi-final 1–0 win over [Scotland](#) on 13 June, before playing in the 1–0 final victory over France, which was to be his eleventh and final appearance for the side.^[2]

He was also called up to [Terry Venables'](#) get-together England squad in April 1995,^[11] but ultimately was never capped for the senior side.

Coaching career

Following his retirement from playing, Hall joined his former club Ipswich Town as a part-time member of the [coaching](#) staff in 2001. He was named as a full-time first-team coach in July 2006, alongside his academy role.^[3] After a restructuring of the academy in March 2009, Hall was made redundant by Ipswich following academy manager [Tony Humes](#) out of the club.^[12]

Both Humes and Hall joined [Colchester United's Academy](#) after leaving Ipswich in 2009.^[13] Ahead of the [2010–11 season](#), Hall was put in charge of the Colchester United reserve team while retaining his first-team and youth-team coaching roles.^[14]

With Tony Humes named as Colchester United [manager](#) following [Joe Dunne's](#) exit on 1 September 2014, Hall was announced as Humes' assistant manager.^[15]

Hall was named as [caretaker manager](#) at Colchester United alongside [John McGreal](#) following Tony Humes dismissal as manager on 26 November 2015.^[16] However, following a 5–1 defeat against [Burton Albion](#) in his only match in charge, he was replaced by Colchester's under-18s coach [Wayne Brown](#), who was named caretaker manager on 2 December. Despite this change, Hall remained with the club,^[17] taking up a one-to-one coaching role within the academy.^[18]